

informed as I was. Like me, they were embarrassed about their lack of financial knowledge. There is a strange phenomenon where everyone feels they should know basic finance despite the fact that almost no one is taught basic finance.

Wanting to address this issue, I launched a program at my school to educate students and prepare them for the financial realities of adulthood. To my surprise, the class has been a hit; the students have been as eager to learn the content as I have been to teach it. In my years teaching the class, I have learned which explanations and examples students connect with and which approaches fall short. When they are presented with the material in a meaningful and approachable way, students readily grasp the concepts and understand the importance of financial literacy.

Working with my students inspired me to write this book. While there are many personal finance books currently available, this one caters specifically to young adults and their particular needs and concerns. As a high school teacher, the adjective I most often hear my students use to describe me is "lame." But the second most often used adjective is "relatable," and that is how I would describe this book. The lessons offered here are meant to help young adults understand the finances of adulthood and develop skills to grow their wealth. If I had known the information in this book when I was seventeen or even twenty-five, I would be much wealthier and less stressed than I am now. I hope my lessons, examples, personal anecdotes, and skill-building exercises will help readers achieve their financial goals and avoid the mistakes that I and so many others have made.